

Mushfiqu. The ball, delivered from over the wicket, veered in sharply and shattered his stumps, ending Bangladesh's second innings right before Lunch. This wasn't just a well-executed delivery but a testament to Bumrah's clever use of timing and variation.

Bumrah's penchant for using his slower deliveries towards the end of

an over has become a tactical hallmark. Nearly half of his slower balls/off-cutters in Test matches are bowled on the fifth or sixth delivery of the over, which has caught many batters off guard. Five of his 11 Test wickets from such deliveries have come in the final ball of the over.

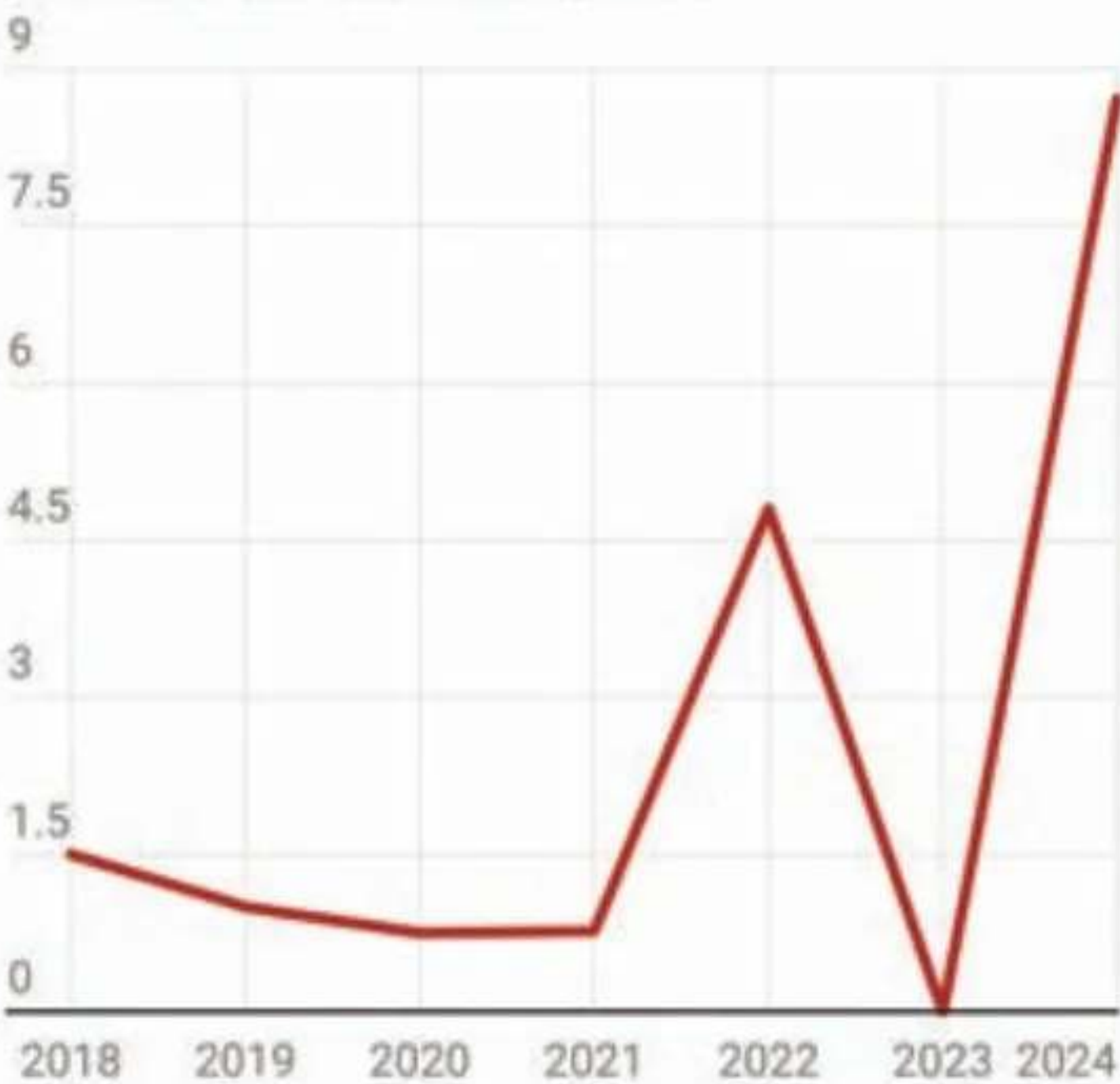
Bumrah's method is similar to a boxer setting up a powerful right

hook by first working his opponent with consistent jabs. He frequently bowls tight lines and lengths throughout the over, creating a rhythm that the batter becomes accustomed to. Then, just as he starts to settle, Bumrah unfurls his slower ball, turning the expected into the unexpected.

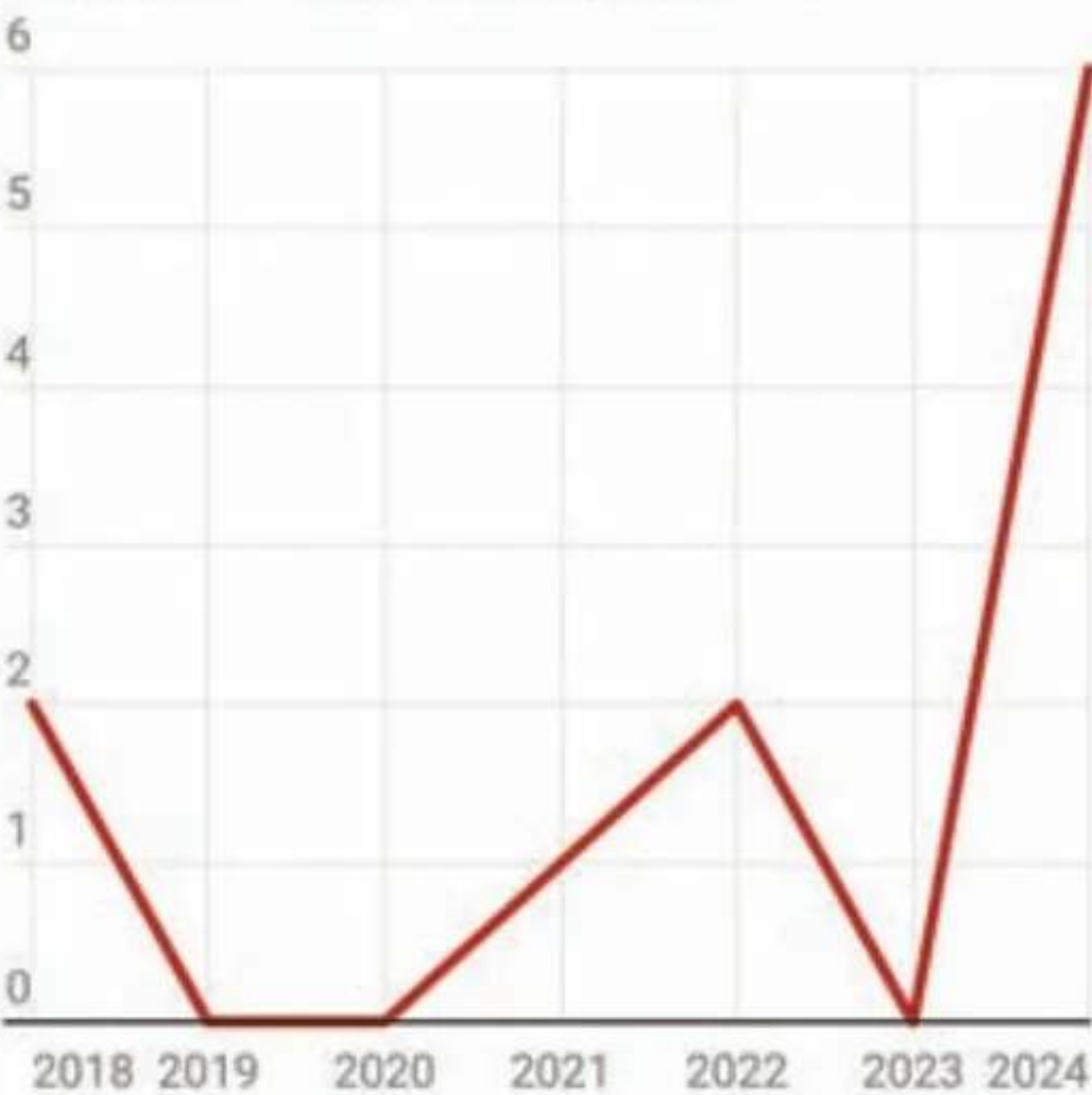
One of the most memorable

Bumrah's increased use of slow balls/off-cutters in Tests

Slow balls/off-cutters per game



Wickets from slow balls/off-cutters



Bumrah's slower balls/off-cutters in Test by ball of the over

6 5 4 1 3 2

Slower ball/off-cutter

